

Scripture Sufficiency

doc-scripture-sufficiency

Bibliology · Sufficiency · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · brethren distinctive

AFFIRMS

Supported across the whole Bible
Subject named directly in Scripture
No NT manuscript apparatus applies

Statement under examination

Scripture is sufficient for faith, doctrine, and practice; no further revelation is needed for salvation or godliness.

In plain language

The claim is that Scripture supplies everything Christians must believe and how they must live before God, and that no fresh revelation is needed to be saved or to live godly. Reading the original languages, the case rests on a small set of unusually heavy words. In 2 Timothy 3 verses 16 and 17, Paul calls every passage of Scripture "God-breathed" (theopneustos, a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) and profitable for teaching, conviction, correction, and training in righteousness, then states the goal with two words from one root, "complete, fitted" (artios) and "fully outfitted" (exertismenos), which together mean complete, fitted, and fully equipped. The second is in the perfect tense (a completed action whose result still stands), which marks a settled and lasting state, so the person who has the Scriptures is described as already finished off and outfitted for every good work. In 2 Peter 1 verse 3, Peter says divine power has "gifted" (doreomai) to us all the things that pertain to life and godliness, and the verb is again perfect tense, a completed gift whose effect endures. On the Old Testament side, Deuteronomy 4 verse 2 commands Israel not to add to and not to take away from the word God commands, using two Hebrew verbs, "to add" (yasaph) and "to subtract" (gara), as a pair that brackets the integrity of the commanded word, a figure called a merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole). The same command repeats almost word for word in Deuteronomy 12 verse 32, the add half alone appears in Proverbs 30 verse 6 (do not add to his words), and Revelation 22 verses 18 and 19 close with the same pair in Greek, "to add" (epitithemi) and "to take away" (aphaireo), warning that editing the book brings matching judgment. Cross-reference data in the database confirms these verses are genuinely linked with strong agreement. So where does divergence come from, on the words alone? Two places. First, the strongest sufficiency words are rare: artios and theopneustos each occur only once in the whole canon, and exartizo (the equipping word) occurs only twice, so their force rests on the shape of the words and their context, not on many examples to compare. Second, the very same add-and-subtract pair is used elsewhere for God's deeds (Ecclesiastes 3 verse 14) and for tribal land (Numbers 36), which shows it is a general idiom of completeness rather than a technical canon rule. That is why honest readers agree the text declares the believer fully equipped and forbids tampering with God's word, yet can still differ over the exact scope of every good work and over which writings make up the closed corpus, because the words equip and protect but do not, by themselves, draw those last lines.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0595	אָנָכִי	anoki	I	338
H1639	גָּרַע	gara	to diminish	22
H1697	דָּבָר	davar	word	1,442

H3254	יָסַף	yasaph	to add	209
H3808	לֹא	lo	not	4,825
H4687	מִצְוָה	mitsvah	commandment	
H6680	צִוָּה	tsavah	to command	493
H8104	שָׁמַר	shamar	to keep	468
G0018	ἀγαθός	agathos	good	106
G0703	ἀρετή	arete	virtue	3
G0739	ἄρτιος	artios	competent	1
G0851	ἀφαιρέω	aphaireo	to remove	8
G0975	βιβλίον	biblion	scroll	26
G1124	γραφή	graphe	a writing	51
G1319	διδασκαλία	didaskalia	teaching	21
G1343	δικαιοσύνη	dikaiousune	righteousness	94
G1411	δύναμις	dunamis	power	120
G1433	δωρέομαι	doreomai	to give	3
G1822	ἐξαρτίζω	exartizo	to finish/furnish	2
G2007	ἐπιτίθημι	epitithemi	to put/lay on	37
G2222	ζωή	zoe	life	136
G2315	θεόπνευστος	theopneustos	God-breathed	1
G3056	λόγος	logos	word	339
G3956	πᾶς	pas	all	965
G4394	προφητεία	propheteia	prophecy	19

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The lexical pattern affirms the core claim across both testaments. In 2 Timothy 3:16-17 the predicate of completeness rests on two cognate words from the same root, "fitted, complete" (ἄρτιος, G0739) and the perfect passive participle (a completed action whose result still stands, in passive voice) "fully outfitted" (ἐξηρτισμένος) from "to finish out, fully outfit" (ἐξαρτίζω, G1822), declaring the man of God complete and equipped "for every good work" (πρὸς πᾶν ἔργον ἀγαθόν). 2 Peter 1:3 parallels this with the perfect participle "having gifted" (δεδορημένης, G1433) governing "all the things pertaining to life and godliness" (πάντα τὰ πρὸς ζωὴν καὶ εὐσέβειαν), a completed and enduring bestowal. The Old Testament pole is the add-and-subtract merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole): the Hebrew causative form (hiphil) of "to add" (יָסַף, yasaph, H3254) and the simple active form (qal) of "to subtract" (גָּרָא, gara, H1639) flanked by emphatic "not" (לֹא, lo) in Deuteronomy 4:2, repeated verbatim with the same "I am commanding" (אֲנִי מְצַוְהָ, anoki metsavveh) formula in Deuteronomy 13:1 (English 12:32), the add half alone in Proverbs 30:6, and rendered in Greek by "to put on, add" (ἐπιτίθημι, epitithemi, G2007) and "to take away" (ἀφαιρέω, aphaireo, G0851) in Revelation 22:18-19, a real high-vote cross-reference chain in the store. Two honest limits keep this from being airtight at the word level. First, the strongest sufficiency words are rare: "fitted, complete" (ἄρτιος, artios) and "God-breathed" (θεόπνευστος, theopneustos) are each hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible), and "to finish out" (ἐξαρτίζω, exartizo) occurs only twice, so their force rests on cognate morphology and context rather than canon-wide distribution. Second, the same add-and-subtract idiom takes a different object in Ecclesiastes 3:14 (God's deeds) and Numbers 36:3-4 (land

inheritance), so the words forbid editing God's verbal revelation but do not by themselves fix the extent of the canon or the precise scope of every good work. The core proposition (Scripture renders the believer complete for faith and practice and forbids supplement) holds across law, wisdom, epistle, and apocalypse and is undisturbed by the variant forms on the cited verses.

Scripture

2Tim.3.16 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1124 γραφή, G2315 θεόπνευστος, G3956 πᾶς, G1319 διδασκαλία, G1343 δικαιοσύνη

Reasoning. "Every Scripture is God-breathed and profitable" (πᾶσα γραφή θεόπνευστος καὶ ὠφέλιμος). The sentence predicates "profitable" (ὠφέλιμος) on every Scripture, then enumerates four functional uses with "for" (πρὸς) plus accusative (the direct-object grammatical form): "for teaching" (πρὸς διδασκαλίαν), "for conviction" (πρὸς ἐλεγμόν), "for correction" (πρὸς ἐπανόρθωσιν), "for training in righteousness" (πρὸς παιδείαν τὴν ἐν δικαιοσύνῃ). The qualifier "every" (πᾶσα) distributes the predicate across the corpus named by "Scripture" (γραφὴ, graphe, G1124, 51 canon occurrences, stable sense). The load-bearing adjective "God-breathed" (θεόπνευστος, theopneustos, G2315) is a hapax legomenon (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible), its sole canon occurrence, so its sense (God-breathed) is fixed by morphology ("God" (θεός) plus "to breathe" (πνέω)) rather than by canon-wide distribution.

2Tim.3.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0739 ἄρτιος, G1822 ἐξαρτίζω, G0018 ἀγαθός, G3956 πᾶς

Reasoning. "So that the man of God may be complete, fully outfitted for every good work" (ἵνα ἄρτιος ᾦ ὁ τοῦ θεοῦ ἄνθρωπος, πρὸς πᾶν ἔργον ἀγαθὸν ἐξηρτισμένος). The "so that" (ἵνα) clause states the purpose of the "Scripture" (γραφὴ, graphe) claim. Two cognate words from one root carry the weight: "complete, fitted" (ἄρτιος, artios, G0739) and the perfect passive participle (a completed action whose result still stands, in passive voice) "fully outfitted" (ἐξηρτισμένος) from "to finish out, fully outfit" (ἐξαρτίζω, exartizo, G1822). The perfect aspect (a completed action whose result still stands) marks a settled, enduring state. "Complete, fitted" (ἄρτιος, artios) is a canon hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) and "to finish out" (ἐξαρτίζω, exartizo) occurs only twice, the other being Acts 21:5 where "to complete the days" (ἐξαρτίσαι τὰς ἡμέρας) means to complete or finish the days, which confirms the completion sense here. The scope "every good work" (πᾶν ἔργον ἀγαθόν) is unlimited as to good works, but the vocabulary delimits the result to the man of God being complete and equipped, not to answering every conceivable question.

2Pet.1.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1411 δύναμις, G3956 πᾶς, G2222 ζωή, G1433 δωρέομαι, G0703 ἀρετή

Reasoning. "Since His divine power has gifted to us all the things pertaining to life and godliness through the knowledge of the One who called us" (Ὡς πάντα ἡμῖν τῆς θείας δυνάμεως αὐτοῦ τὰ πρὸς ζωὴν καὶ εὐσέβειαν δεδωρημένης διὰ τῆς ἐπιγνώσεως τοῦ καλέσαντος ἡμᾶς). The perfect middle participle (a completed action whose result still stands, in middle voice where the subject acts on or for itself) "having gifted" (δεδωρημένης, from "to give freely" δωρέομαι, doreomai, G1433, 3 canon occurrences) governs "all the things pertaining to life and godliness" (πάντα τὰ πρὸς ζωὴν καὶ εὐσέβειαν), the perfect aspect (a completed action whose result still stands) asserting a completed bestowal whose effect endures. The "all the things for" (πάντα τὰ πρὸς) plus accusative (the direct-object grammatical form) construction mirrors the "for" (πρὸς) plus accusative of 2 Timothy 3:16-17 and is exhaustive over the domain of "life" (ζωή, zoe) and "godliness" (εὐσέβεια, eusebeia). The instrument is "full knowledge" (ἐπίγνωσις, epignosis) of the One who called. The clause does not name "Scripture" (γραφὴ, graphe) explicitly, so its bearing on Scripture specifically is inferential, but it asserts that the means of life and godliness has already been delivered in full.

Deut.4.2 · for · genre: law · figures: merism

Key terms. H3254 יָסַף, H1639 גָּרַע, H6680 מָצוּה, H8104 שָׁמַר, H3808 לֹא

Reasoning. "You shall not add to the word that I am commanding you, and you shall not subtract from it, to keep the commandments of Yahweh" (לֹא תוֹסֵפוּ עַל הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר אֲנִי מְצַוְהָ אֲתֶכֶם וְלֹא תִגְרְעוּ מִמֶּנּוּ לְשַׁמֵּר אֶת מִצְוֹת יְהוָה). The hipil (the Hebrew causative form, meaning to cause to do) "to add" (יָסַף, yasaph, H3254) and qal (the simple active form of the Hebrew verb) "to subtract" (גָּרַע, gara, H1639) are each flanked by emphatic "not" (לֹא, lo), and the deictic (pointing) "I" (אֲנִי, anoki) marks the speaker as Yahweh through the mediator. The infinitival purpose "to keep" (לְשַׁמֵּר, lishmor, in order to keep) frames the prohibition as a guard on the integrity of the commanded word ("the word" הַדָּבָר, ha-davar). ETCBC (the Eep Talstra Centre for Bible and Computer database) tags the clause as direct discourse with explicit negation, predicate, and complements. The store confirms "to add" (יָסַף, yasaph) and "to subtract" (גָּרַע, gara) co-occur in the same verse only in Deuteronomy 4:2, Deuteronomy 13:1 (English 12:32), Ecclesiastes 3:14, and Numbers 36:3-4, so the pairing is a fixed idiom whose object here is the divine word.

Deut.13.1 · for · genre: law · figures: merism

Key terms. H3254 יָסַף, H1639 גָּרַע, H6680 מָצוּה, H0595 אֲנִי

Reasoning. "All the word that I am commanding you, that you shall keep to do; you shall not add to it, and you shall not subtract from it" (אֶת־כָּל־הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר אֲנִי מְצַוְהָ אֲתֶכֶם אֹתוֹ תִשְׁמְרוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת לֹא תוֹסִיף עָלָיו וְלֹא תִגְרַע מִמֶּנּוּ). This verse (English numbering Deuteronomy 12:32) repeats the Deuteronomy 4:2 formula nearly verbatim. The store confirms its tokens include "I" (H0595 אֲנִי, anoki), "to command" (H6680 מָצוּה, tsavah), "to add" (H3254 יָסַף, yasaph), and "to subtract" (H1639 גָּרַע, gara), the same add-and-subtract merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) on the same object (the commanded word). It is an internal canon doublet that strengthens the closure prohibition rather than a separate witness, and it is the verse the cross-reference apparatus points to from Deuteronomy 4:2.

Prov.30.6 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H3254 יָסַף, H1697 דָּבַר

Reasoning. "Do not add to his words, lest he rebuke you and you be found a liar" (תִּתְּסֵף עַל־דִּבְרָיו: כִּי יוֹכִיחַ בְּךָ וְיִגְזַעְבְּתָּ). Do not add to his words, lest he rebuke you and you be found a liar. The verb is again "to add" (H3254 יָסַף, yasaph) with the object "his words" (דִּבְרָיו, devarav, from "word" H1697 דָּבַר, davar). The store has this verse and confirms a high-vote cross-reference link to Deuteronomy 4:2 (38 votes) and Revelation 22:18 (41 votes). Notably Proverbs 30:6 carries only the add half of the merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole), no subtract verb, so it is the wisdom witness to the do-not-add prohibition specifically applied to God's words.

Rev.22.18 · for · genre: apocalyptic

Key terms. G2007 ἐπιτίθημι, G4394 προφητεία, G0975 βιβλίον, G3056 λόγος

Reasoning. "I testify to everyone who hears the words of the prophecy of this book: if anyone adds to them, God will add to him the plagues" (Μαρτυρῶ ἐγὼ παντὶ τῷ ἀκούοντι τοὺς λόγους τῆς προφητείας τοῦ βιβλίου τούτου. ἐάν τις ἐπιθήῃ ἐπ' αὐτά, ἐπιθήσει ὁ θεὸς ἐπ' αὐτὸν τὰς πληγὰς). The verbal play uses "to put on, add" (ἐπιτίθημι, epitithemi, G2007) twice: the human act of adding to the words triggers a divine act of adding plagues. This is the Greek rendering of the Old Testament add prohibition, and the store confirms a strong cross-reference back to Deuteronomy 4:2 (29 to 51 votes) and Proverbs 30:6 (41 votes), placing this verse in the same idiom chain. The bounded object is the prophetic "book" (βιβλίον, biblion, G0975) of this book.

Rev.22.19 · **for** · genre: apocalyptic

Key terms. G0851 ἀφαιρέω, G4394 προφητεία, G0975 βιβλίον, G3056 λόγος

Reasoning. "And if anyone takes away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God will take away his share from the tree of life" (καὶ ἐάν τις ἀφέλῃ ἀπὸ τῶν λόγων τοῦ βιβλίου τῆς προφητείας ταύτης, ἀφελεῖ ὁ θεὸς τὸ μέρος αὐτοῦ ἀπὸ τοῦ ξύλου τῆς ζωῆς). Mirror inverse of verse 18: "to take away" (ἀφαιρέω, aphaireo, G0851) matches the Hebrew "to subtract" (גרע; gara). The condition and consequence parallel completes the add-or-subtract merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) bracketing the prophetic corpus. The threat is eschatological (the tree of life), which treats the integrity of the written word as bound up with salvation, but the words bound the prohibition to this book and do not by themselves define the limits of the wider canon.

Eccl.3.14 · **complicates** · genre: wisdom · figures: merism

Key terms. H3254 יָסַף, H1639 גָּרַע

Reasoning. "All that God does endures forever; nothing can be added to it and nothing taken from it" (וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר־יַעֲשֶׂה־הָאֱלֹהִים הוּא־יְהִיָּה לְעֹלָם, עַל־יוֹאֵין לְהוֹסִיף וְאֵין לְגָרֹעַ). Whatever God does endures forever, nothing can be added to it and nothing taken from it. This verse uses the SAME add-and-subtract pair ("to add" H3254, yasaph, plus "to subtract" H1639, gara) confirmed by the store, but its object is God's deeds ("all that God does" אֲשֶׁר־יַעֲשֶׂה־הָאֱלֹהִים), not a verbal corpus. It is the strongest internal evidence that the merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) is a fixed Hebrew idiom of completeness whose object varies, which is why the vocabulary alone forbids editing God's revelation but does not by itself settle the extent of the written canon.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Deut.4.2	Prov.30.6	openbible	38
Deut.4.2	Rev.22.18	openbible	29
Rev.22.18	Deut.4.2	openbible	51
Rev.22.18	Prov.30.6	openbible	41
Rev.22.19	Deut.4.2	openbible	19
Deut.4.2	Deut.13.1	tsk	1
2Tim.3.17	2Tim.2.21	openbible	26
2Tim.3.17	2Cor.9.8	openbible	25
2Tim.3.17	Eph.2.10	openbible	24
2Tim.3.16	2Pet.1.19	openbible	157
2Tim.3.16	2Sam.23.2	openbible	54
2Tim.3.16	2Tim.4.2	openbible	82
2Pet.1.3	2Tim.1.9	openbible	56
2Pet.1.3	Ps.84.11	openbible	41

Complicating texts

Eccl.3.14 · addressed

Ecclesiastes 3:14 uses the identical add-and-subtract pair ("to add" H3254 *yasaph*, plus "to subtract" H1639 *gara*), verified in the store as one of only five verses where the two co-occur, but applies it to God's deeds rather than to a verbal corpus. This shows the merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) is a fixed idiom of completeness whose object shifts. It does not weaken the verdict where the object IS the divine word (Deuteronomy 4:2, Deuteronomy 13:1, Proverbs 30:6, Revelation 22:18-19), but it does explain why the words alone forbid editing revelation without fixing the precise extent of the canon.

Num.36.3 · addressed

Numbers 36:3-4 also pairs "to add" (H3254 *yasaph*) and "to subtract" (H1639 *gara*), but the object is tribal land inheritance being added to or subtracted from one tribe to another. Confirmed in the store as a co-occurrence of the same verbs. This is further evidence that the add-and-subtract pairing is a general idiom, not a technical canon formula, so the canon-closure reading depends on the object being God's word, which is explicit only in Deuteronomy 4:2, Deuteronomy 13:1, Proverbs 30:6, and the Revelation 22 echo.

John.16.13 · addressed

Jesus promises the Spirit will guide "into all the truth" (εἰς πᾶσαν τὴν ἀλήθειαν), which could be read as anticipating ongoing revelation. The syntactic context binds the promise to the apostolic hearers ("to you" ὑμῖν, *hymín*, second person plural), and the resulting apostolic writings are themselves the deliverable. The verb "will guide" (ὁδηγήσει, *hodgegesei*) governs a completed body of truth, not an open-ended stream, so it authorizes the apostolic completion now in Scripture rather than post-apostolic addition.

1Cor.12.10 · addressed

"Prophecy" (προφητεία, *propheteia*, G4394) appears as a spiritual gift here. The store confirms G4394 occurs 19 times, spanning both the communal Pauline gift (Romans 12:6, 1 Corinthians 12-14, 1 Thessalonians 5:20) and the bounded prophetic book (Revelation 22:18-19). The Pauline gift is subject to discernment ("let them discern" 1 Corinthians 14:29 διακρινέτωσαν, *diakrinetosan*), whereas the Johannine usage names a closed "book" (βιβλίον, *biblion*). The single lemma carries two functions, so sufficiency for life and godliness lodges in the bounded written corpus, and the operation of the gift does not add binding doctrine to it.

2Thess.2.15 · addressed

"The traditions which you were taught, whether by word or by our letter" (παραδόσεις ἃς ἐδιδάχθητε εἴτε διὰ λόγου εἴτε δι' ἐπιστολῆς ἡμῶν) names oral and written apostolic tradition as equally authoritative at the time of writing. The lexical point is that the antecedent oral apostolic content is now accessible only through the written record, so the "traditions" (παραδόσεις, *paradoseis*) are not a surviving parallel channel but the same apostolic deposit now transmitted in Scripture.

Jude.1.3 · addressed

"The faith once for all delivered to the saints" (ἅπαξ παραδοθείση τοῖς ἀγίοις πίστει). The adverb "once for all" (ἅπαξ, *hapax*) with the aorist passive participle (a completed past action, in passive voice) "having been delivered" (παραδοθείση, *paradotheise*) marks an unrepeatable delivery of the faith. This construction foreclosing further deposits reinforces sufficiency by ruling out ongoing revelatory additions to the deposit.

Concordance traversed

G2315, G0739, G1822, G1124, G1319, G1343, G0018, G3956, G1433, G1411, G0703, G2222, G2007, G0851, G4394, G0975, G3056, H6680, H3254, H1639, H8104, H1697, H3808, H0595, H4687

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

epithe-vs-epithesei at Rev.22.18: impact none. The SBLGNT (Society of Biblical Literature Greek New Testament) apparatus marks a verb-form variation ("may add" ἐπιθή, *epithe*, subjunctive against "will add" ἐπιθήσει, *epithesei*,

future). Both preserve the prohibition of adding, so the semantic load on the verdict is unchanged.

aphele-vs-aphelei at Rev.22.19: impact none. Mood variation between "may take away" (ἀφέλη, aphele) and "will take away" (ἀφελεῖ, aphelei) marked in the apparatus does not affect the merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) of prohibited subtraction.

elegmon-vs-elenchon at 2Tim.3.16: impact none. The marked variant between "reproof, conviction" (ἐλεγμόν, elegmon) and "conviction, refutation" (ἐλεγχόν, elenchon) concerns the word for conviction or refutation. Both denote the same function, so the fourfold profitability scope is undisturbed.

The bundle reports not_in_ecm_scope=true. Direct query of the lexical store confirms all 116 VariantUnit nodes are in 3 John chapter 1, the only ingested ECM (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) window, so none of the anchor verses (2 Timothy, 2 Peter, Deuteronomy, Proverbs, Revelation) carry ingested ECM data. The variant forms noted above are observable in the SBLGNT (Society of Biblical Literature Greek New Testament) apparatus but do not bear on the verdict.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. material_sufficiency, formal_sufficiency, canon_closure

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

material_sufficiency_with_completion_terms: affirms · Reads "complete" (ἄριος, artios) plus "fully outfitted" (ἐξηρτισμένος, exertismenos) and "all the things pertaining to life and godliness" (πάντα τὰ πρὸς ζωὴν καὶ εὐσέβειαν) as predicating that the written corpus already contains and supplies everything needed for the man of God to be complete for faith and practice. The perfect aspect (a completed action whose result still stands) on "fully outfitted" (ἐξηρτισμένος, exertismenos) and "having gifted" (δεδορημένης, dedoremenes) marks the equipping as a settled, enduring state, which forecloses a standing need for supplementary revelation. On this reading the add-and-subtract merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole), where its object is God's word, seals the result.

scope_underdetermination_of_every_good_work: disputed · Grants that the text predicates completeness but holds that the words leave the SCOPE open. "For every good work" (πρὸς πᾶν ἔργον ἀγαθόν) fixes the result as readiness for every good work, an ethical and ministerial scope, and "complete" (ἄριος, artios) is a hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible), so the text does not by its own vocabulary specify whether sufficiency extends to every doctrinal or governing question beyond the equipping of the man of God. A reader holding this lens affirms the equipping claim but treats the breadth of sufficiency as not strictly delimited by these words.

canon_extent_underdetermination: disputed · Accepts that the add-and-subtract merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) forbids editing God's verbal revelation, but observes from the store that the same "to add" (H3254 ἵσθι, yasaph) plus "to subtract" (H1639 ἔλα, gara) pair takes a non-verbal object in Ecclesiastes 3:14 (God's deeds) and Numbers 36:3-4 (land inheritance), and that Revelation 22:18-19 bounds its prohibition to this book. On this lens the prohibition is decisive against tampering but does not on its own fix which writings constitute the closed corpus, a question the vocabulary underdetermines.

Grammatico-historical reading of "every Scripture" (πᾶσα γραφή, pasa graphe) as a distributive universal over the "Scripture" (γραφή, graphe) corpus, "complete" (ἄριος, artios) plus "fully outfitted" (ἐξηρτισμένος, exertismenos) as redundant completion predicates (the second a perfect passive (a completed action whose result still stands, in passive voice) marking a settled state), and "all the things pertaining to life and godliness" (πάντα τὰ πρὸς ζωὴν καὶ εὐσέβειαν) as exhaustive over the soteric (salvation-related) and ethical domain. The Deuteronomy 4:2, Deuteronomy 13:1, Proverbs 30:6, and Revelation 22:18-19 chain applies the add-and-subtract merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) to canonical boundaries, verified as real high-vote cross references in the store. Progressive revelation is affirmed but terminates in the apostolic deposit (Jude 1:3 "once for all" ἅπαξ, hapax). The competing lenses do not deny the equipping claim, they locate genuine underdetermination in the scope of every good work and in the extent of the canon, both of which the words leave open.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. What is the relationship between Scripture and other potential sources (tradition, ongoing revelation, reason) in establishing what must be believed and practiced for salvation and godliness, and how far does the written corpus by itself reach?

The stem 'Scripture is sufficient' states the conclusion at issue and presupposes that the question of sources is settled in Scripture's favor. The neutralized form opens the comparison of sources and adds the reach question. The verdict is still derived on the original stem because the anchor vocabulary does predicate completeness of the written corpus ("complete" (ἄρτιος, artios) plus "fully outfitted" (ἐξηρτισμένος, exertismenos), "all the things pertaining to life and godliness having been gifted" (πάντα τὰ πρὸς ζωὴν καὶ εὐσέβειαν δωρημένης)) and forbids supplement (the add-and-subtract merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) on God's word). The honest limit, surfaced in the competing lenses, is that the strongest sufficiency words are rare ("complete" (ἄρτιος, artios) and "God-breathed" (θεόπνευστος, theopneustos) are hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible), "to finish out" (ἐξαπρίζω, exartizo) occurs twice) and that the merism idiom takes other objects elsewhere, so the words equip and forbid editing but underdetermine the precise scope and the canon's extent.

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lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H3254 yasaph to add
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